a FlexLifeFi K-12 program

Ten Anchor Lessons

Standards, materials, procedure, differentiation - ready to teach.

Grade 12 year theme — Launch-Ready Entrepreneurship.
The 9-12 band is built for the adults who will scrutinize: parents, teachers, administrators.

CONTENTS

Inside this volume

Grade 12 · Lesson Plans · the magazine version of the master document, set for adults to read end-to-end.

01 Lesson 1 — The Venture Portfolio (Cash V1 Launch)

02 Lesson 2 — Premortem for Three Ventures

03 Lesson 3 — The Founder's Journal Routine (Cash V3 Launch)

04 Lesson 4 — Three Statements That Tell the Truth

05 Lesson 5 — Unit Economics Under Two Scenarios

06 Lesson 6 — The Real Customer Conversation (5-of-5)

07 Lesson 7 — The 1-Page Legal/Ethical Checklist

08 Lesson 8 — The 90-Day Plan and the First Variance Report

09 Lesson 9 — The Founder's Leadership Statement

10 Lesson 10 — The Capstone Defense (Defense Day)

11 Senior expert upgrade pack — Grade 12 worked examples, contracts, runway, misconceptions

12 ROUND 2 PATCH — Common Misconceptions (Grade 12)

13 ROUND 2 PATCH — Multi-Class Branching Scenario (Grade 12)

14 ROUND 2 PATCH — Contracts Mini-Module (Grade 12, NEW — Lesson 7)

15 ROUND 2 PATCH — Runway Worked Examples (Grade 12, NEW)

16 ROUND 2 PATCH — Weekly Bookkeeping Rhythm Reference Card (Grade 12, NEW)

17 ROUND 2 PATCH — MVP-Testing Depth Pass

18 ROUND 2 PATCH — Hiring Basics Integration (Grade 12)

19 ROUND 2 PATCH — Forward-Reference Grade 9 Conflict-Style in Founders Leadership Statement

20 ROUND 2 PATCH — Teacher Move Set (Grade 12)

GRADE 12 · LESSON PLANS

Ten Anchor Lesso

Founder-defensible plans built on evidence, not enthusiasm.

12

Ten fully fleshed lessons spanning the capstone year. Each lesson is built to pass the picks-up-Monday test: a teacher with no prior prep should be able to read this Sunday night and teach it Monday morning. Standards are cited at the benchmark level — verbatim. Differentiation notes are specific and actionable. Vocabulary is included for each lesson. Time blocks default to 60 minutes (one block-schedule period) unless noted; longer blocks are flagged.

WITH CASH - 9-12 VOICE

"Revenue is loud. Contribution margin is true. Compute one number this week."

Lessons are sampled across the year so the full arc is visible:

1. (Week 1) Cash V1 launch + the Venture Portfolio
2. (Week 4) Premortem for Three Ventures
3. (Week 9) Cash V3 launch + the Founder's Journal Routine
4. (Week 12) Three Statements That Tell the Truth
5. (Week 15) Unit Economics Under Two Scenarios
6. (Week 21) The Real Customer Conversation — 5-of-5
7. (Week 24) The 1-Page Legal/Ethical Checklist
8. (Week 30) The 90-Day Plan and the First Variance Report
9. (Week 33) The Founder's Leadership Statement
10. (Week 36) The Capstone Defense — Defense Day Itself

Lesson 1 — The Venture Portfolio (Cash V1 Launch)

> **"Revenue is loud. Contribution margin is true. Compute one number this week."**
>
> - CASH, GRADE 12

Grade band: 9-12 **Time:** 60 minutes **Unit:** 1 — Portfolio thinking and the founder's journal
Topic area: BAVC + LRCI · Year launch

Objectives

By the end of this lesson, students will be able to:

- Generate three candidate ventures, each named with a one-sentence customer/value description.
- Explain in writing why one of the three is a better starting point than the other two, citing at least two reasons grounded in market, fit, or capital.

Standards alignment

- **CCSS-ELA W.11-12.1:** Write arguments to support claims in an analysis of substantive topics or texts, using valid reasoning and relevant and sufficient evidence.
- **Jump$tart Standard 6 (Financial Decision Making), Benchmark 12-1:** Apply reliable information and systematic decision making — applied to portfolio selection.
- **CASEL Self-Awareness:** Identifying personal strengths, areas for growth.

Materials

- Cash Video #1 ("Three doors, one room") — 2:50.
- Capstone Journal (notebook or digital — same one carried all year).
- Venture Portfolio one-pager template (provided): three columns, six rows (Customer, Need, How you'd reach them, Smallest version you could test, What would have to be true to work, What you'd need from yourself).
- Sticky notes, pens, a wall of butcher paper labeled "Year 12 Ventures."

Vocabulary

- **Venture portfolio** — a structured comparison of two or more business ideas, used to choose where to invest your time.
- **Founder-market fit (simplified)** — the match between who you are and what the market needs. (Asked: what do you bring that this venture would lean on?)
- **Opportunity cost** — what you give up by choosing one venture over another.

Procedure

1. ENGAGE — CASH VIDEO + DOOR QUESTION (~7 MIN)

Play Cash Video #1. As the video ends, post the prompt:

> **"Imagine three doors. Behind each is a year of your life running a different venture. Which door do you walk through, and how do you decide which one before you commit?"**

Pair-share for 2 minutes. Cold-call two students. (You're surfacing the central year-long question in five minutes flat.)

2. EXPLORE — GENERATE THREE VENTURES (~18 MIN)

Each student fills three columns of the Portfolio template. Each venture must be specific enough to fail. Examples of too vague: "a clothing brand," "an app." Examples of specific enough: "a custom-fit t-shirt service for college freshmen at our local university who want a single high-quality moving-in shirt," or "a tutoring service for 8th graders preparing for the geometry placement test, run after school in the public library."

Confer with five students. Sharpening question: "Which people, exactly? Tell me one behavior, not a demographic."

3. EXPLAIN — THE THREE LENSES (~8 MIN)

Walk through the three lenses portfolios get evaluated through:

- **Market.** Is there a customer who knows they have this problem and is already paying — in time, money, or attention — to solve it badly?
- **Fit.** Are you the right person to do this? What in your background, network, or interests makes you a non-obvious match?
- **Capital.** What would the smallest version cost to test? Where would the time and money come from?

These are the same three lenses that will appear on the Capstone Defense rubric. Be explicit: the year's defense is built on this frame.

4. APPLY — CHOOSE AND DEFEND (~20 MIN)

Each student picks one of their three. Writes a 6-8 sentence defense in the Capstone Journal:

- Customer (specific people).
- Why you (fit reasons).
- What would have to be true (the most fragile assumption).
- What the smallest test costs.
- Two reasons this venture beats the other two.

Confer. Push on the most fragile assumption. "If that's wrong, what do you do?"

5. CLOSE — PIN THE PORTFOLIO (~7 MIN)

Each student posts their portfolio on the "Year 12 Ventures" wall. Brief gallery walk. End with: "You'll walk past this wall every week. By Week 9 some of these will look different. That's normal. The portfolio thinks for you."

Differentiation

- **ELL:** Sentence frames provided for each column. Native-language brainstorming allowed; English on the final defense paragraph. Pair with an ally for the gallery walk.
- **IEP/504:** Allow voice-recorded ventures with a peer scribe. Two-venture comparison acceptable; the third can be added Week 2.
- **Advanced learners:** Push toward a fourth venture as a "control" (something obviously bad to compare against). Add an explicit opportunity cost paragraph: what's the year's best-case if you skip your chosen venture and bank the time?

Assessment

Formative: Walk during the generation phase; confer with at least 8 students. Read the closing defense paragraph. **Summative:** The Portfolio one-pager is the first artifact in the Capstone. The chosen venture is filed; pivot windows allow change in Weeks 9, 18, 27.

Closure

Same as #5.

Homework / Extension

Bring back two artifacts on Wednesday: (1) one piece of evidence (a screenshot, a quote, a count of something) that supports the customer claim; (2) one question you don't yet know the answer to.

Teacher notes

- Some students will arrive with a venture they've been running for years. Honor it; they still build the portfolio. The point is to compare, not to invent.
- A student says "I don't have any ideas." Coach: what do people ask you to help them with? what irritates you that nobody fixes? Gently: don't model a venture on something that bores you.
- Resist the urge to evaluate venture quality on Day 1. The evidence will do that across the year.

Lesson 2 — Premortem for Three Ventures

Grade band: 9-12 **Time:** 60 minutes **Unit:** 1 — Portfolio thinking and the founder's journal
Topic area: PSIG + LRCI · Decision quality

Objectives

By the end of this lesson, students will be able to:

- Conduct a structured 10-minute premortem on each of their three portfolio ventures.
- Identify the single most likely failure mode for each, with a one-sentence mitigation.

Standards alignment

- **CCSS-Math S-MD.B.7:** Analyze decisions and strategies using probability concepts.
- **CASEL Responsible Decision-Making:** Analyze consequences of various actions for personal, social, and collective well-being.
- **NGSS-ETS HS-ETS1-1:** Analyze a major global challenge to specify qualitative and quantitative criteria.

Materials

- Premortem template (provided): one page per venture with sections — Imagined Future, Failure Story, Top 3 Causes, Most Likely Cause, Mitigation.
- Capstone Journal.
- A timer, a quiet room.

Vocabulary

- **Premortem** — a thinking exercise in which you imagine that the venture has already failed twelve months from now, and work backward to identify why.
- **Mitigation** — a specific action that reduces the likelihood or impact of a named failure.

Procedure

1. ENGAGE — TWO STORIES (~8 MIN)

Tell two short, specific stories. Story A: a venture from last year that failed because the founder didn't talk to enough customers — they assumed and were wrong. Story B: a venture that nearly failed, but the founder ran a premortem in Week 6 and switched approach early enough. Both stories made up; both realistic.

Ask: "What's the difference between guessing what could go wrong and naming what would?"

2. EXPLAIN — THE PREMORTEM MOVE (~7 MIN)

The premortem flips the frame. Instead of what could happen? you write the venture failed. What did we miss? The grammar is past-tense, specific, and unflinching.

Walk through the template:

- **Imagined Future.** It's December of next year. The venture is dead.
- **Failure Story.** Two paragraphs in past tense — what happened?
- **Top 3 Causes.** Specific.
- **Most Likely Cause.** Pick one.
- **Mitigation.** A specific action you'd take this month.

3. APPLY — THREE PREMORTEMS (~35 MIN)

Each student runs a premortem on each of their three portfolio ventures. ~10 minutes per venture, with a 1-minute reset between.

Confer rule: don't sharpen the writing yet. Ask: "Is this cause specific enough to act on?" Push from "I'd run out of money" to "I'd run out of money in month 4 because customer acquisition cost was 3× what I assumed and I had no way to lower it."

4. CLOSE — PICK THE ONE WORTH MITIGATING (~10 MIN)

Each student writes a closing journal entry: "Across my three premortems, the failure mode I'm most worried about is **. The action I'm taking this month to mitigate it is** ."

Differentiation

- **ELL:** Sentence frames for the failure-story section. Allow native-language drafting.
- **IEP/504:** Reduce to two premortems instead of three; extended time on the closing entry.
- **Advanced learners:** Add a quantified probability — what's your honest gut probability this venture is dead in 12 months? Then ask: what's the bar you'd need to see this month to revise that down by 20 percentage points?

Assessment

Formative: Confer notes during the writing phase. **Summative:** Premortems are filed; the most-likely cause for the chosen Capstone venture becomes a watch-item all year.

Closure

Same as #4.

Homework / Extension

Show your premortem to one trusted adult who's run something — a parent, neighbor, coach, teacher in another department. Bring back: did they spot a fourth cause you missed?

Teacher notes

- Some students resist the past-tense framing. Hold the line — present tense reads as anxiety, past tense reads as analysis.
- The premortem will reveal which student is afraid of being wrong about their idea. Gently: being wrong on Day 1 is the deal. The premortem is how you pay less for being wrong later.

Lesson 3 — The Founder's Journal Routine (Cash V3 Launch)

Grade band: 9-12 **Time:** 50 minutes **Unit:** 1 — Portfolio thinking and the founder's journal
Topic area: PSIG + LTO · Reflective practice

Objectives

By the end of this lesson, students will be able to:

- Establish a weekly founder's journal routine with four prompts.
- Write the first journal entry following the routine.

Standards alignment

- **CCSS-ELA W.11-12.10:** Write routinely over extended time frames for a range of tasks, purposes, and audiences.
- **CASEL Self-Awareness:** Recognizing strengths, areas for growth.
- **Jump$tart Standard 6 (Financial Decision Making), Benchmark 12-1:** Apply reliable information and systematic decision making — applied to evidence-based reflection.

Materials

- Cash Video #3 ("The journal is a forecast about you") — 2:45.
- Capstone Journal.
- A printed Journal Prompt Card (provided): What evidence did I gather this week? · What did I change my mind about? · What's the most fragile assumption right now? · What am I doing next week?

Vocabulary

- **Founder's journal** — a weekly written record of evidence collected, beliefs revised, and next moves planned.
- **Idea evolution** — the visible track of how your venture concept has changed in response to evidence.

Procedure

1. ENGAGE — CASH VIDEO + PAIR SHARE (~8 MIN)

Play Cash Video #3. Discuss: "If you wrote a journal entry every week for 36 weeks, what would your future self thank you for putting in it?"

2. EXPLAIN — THE FOUR PROMPTS (~10 MIN)

Walk through the prompt card. Emphasize:

- Evidence means specifics — quotes, counts, screenshots, observations. Not "I felt good about it."
- Changed my mind means a real revision. If nothing changed, write "nothing changed and here's why I'm worried about that."
- Most fragile assumption updates weekly. Watch your own pattern.
- Next week names one or two specific moves, not a vibe.

3. APPLY — WRITE ENTRY #1 (~25 MIN)

Each student writes their first founder's journal entry following the prompt card. Confer with 8 students. Push for specificity. "That's a feeling. Can you turn it into a count, a quote, or a screenshot?"

4. CLOSE — CALENDAR THE ROUTINE (~7 MIN)

Each student picks the day and time of their weekly journal entry. Writes it on the inside cover of the Capstone Journal. The teacher writes the same on the board: "Friday Capstone class includes 10 minutes of journaling. Outside-class entries are due by Sunday night."

Differentiation

- **ELL:** Allow journal entries in native language; require English summary at the top of each entry (3 sentences). Pre-translate the prompt card.
- **IEP/504:** Voice-recorded entries with transcription support. The four prompts can be answered out of order.
- **Advanced learners:** Add a fifth prompt: what's a question I want to bring to the next class discussion? Use the entries as the basis for student-led discussions in Weeks 18 and 27.

Assessment

Formative: Quick read of Entry #1. **Summative:** Journal must contain 10+ entries by Week 36, and one explicit pivot or kill decision with reasoning. This is a Capstone Defense artifact — graded against the Reflection Writing Rubric (full 5-criteria version per the Rubric Bank's 9-12 scale notes).

Closure

Same as #4.

Homework / Extension

Read your last entry every Sunday before you write the new one. Notice what's repeating.

Teacher notes

- The journal is the most-skipped artifact in the year. Protect the Friday class time. Write while they write.
- A student says "nothing happened this week worth writing about." Coach: that's a journal entry. Why didn't anything happen? What did you skip?

Lesson 4 — Three Statements That Tell the Truth

Grade band: 9-12 **Time:** 90 minutes (block) **Unit:** 2 — The full financial pack **Topic area:** MFL · Financial literacy

Objectives

By the end of this lesson, students will be able to:

- Define and distinguish the P&L (income statement), the cash flow statement, and the balance sheet.
- Identify which statement answers each of three founder questions: Am I profitable? Am I going to run out of money? What do I own and owe?

Standards alignment

- **Jump$tart Standard 1 (Spending and Saving), Benchmark 12-2:** Develop a system for keeping and using financial records.
- **CCSS-Math A-CED.A.2:** Create equations in two or more variables to represent relationships between quantities.
- **CEE Standard 1 (Earning Income), Grade 12:** Income from self-employment is not the same as profit.

Materials

- Two printed sample financial packs (one a real anonymized small venture, one a teaching-case version).
- A blank three-statement template per student (Google Sheet link or printed).

- A six-question diagnostic (provided).

Vocabulary

- **P&L (income statement)** — a summary of revenue minus expenses over a period (typically a month or year). Answers: am I profitable?
- **Cash flow statement** — a summary of cash in and cash out over a period, showing the timing. Answers: am I going to run out of money?
- **Balance sheet** — a snapshot at a moment in time of what the venture owns (assets), what it owes (liabilities), and the difference (equity). Answers: what do I own and owe?
- **Three-statement consistency** — the property that a properly built P&L, cash flow, and balance sheet tie to each other. Profit flows to equity; cash on the balance sheet matches the ending cash on the cash flow statement.

Procedure

1. ENGAGE — A FOUNDER WHO WAS PROFITABLE AND BROKE (~10 MIN)

Tell the (real, anonymized) story of a small services venture that booked $200,000 in revenue, recognized $40,000 of profit on the P&L — and ran out of cash in October because customers paid late. Show the simplified P&L (looks great) and the simplified cash flow (looks terrifying).

Ask: "How can both be true?"

2. EXPLAIN — THREE STATEMENTS, THREE QUESTIONS (~15 MIN)

Walk through the three statements with the 3-question framing.

Visual: build a single decision tree on the board.

- Am I profitable? → P&L.
- Am I going to run out of money? → Cash flow.
- What do I own and owe? → Balance sheet.

Three-statement consistency: profit on the P&L flows to retained earnings on the balance sheet. Cash on the balance sheet equals ending cash on the cash flow statement. Quick demo with a five-line example.

3. APPLY — READ TWO SAMPLE PACKS (~30 MIN)

In pairs, students read the two sample financial packs. For each pack, they answer the six diagnostic questions:

1. Was this venture profitable in Year 1? (P&L)
2. Did this venture have any month with negative ending cash? (Cash flow)
3. What was the largest single expense category? (P&L)

4. What did the venture own (assets) at year-end? (Balance sheet)
5. What did it owe (liabilities)? (Balance sheet)
6. Looking at all three together — would you have invested in this venture? Why?

4. APPLY — FIRST PASS ON YOUR OWN VENTURE (~25 MIN)

Open the blank three-statement template. Each student fills in the P&L row labels for their Capstone venture (one revenue line, four to six expense categories). Cash flow and balance sheet stay blank for now — those build over the next two lessons.

5. CLOSE — ONE SENTENCE ON EACH STATEMENT (~10 MIN)

Capstone Journal entry: "For my venture, the P&L mostly tells me **. The cash flow will mostly tell me** . The balance sheet will mostly tell me __."

Differentiation

- **ELL:** Bilingual financial-terms glossary provided; allow first-pass entries in native language for the labels. Pair with a strong English speaker for the sample-pack reading.
- **IEP/504:** Provide pre-filled row labels so students can focus on understanding rather than generating. Allow extra time on the diagnostic.
- **Advanced learners:** Push toward three-statement consistency — an arithmetic check across the two sample packs that profit ties to retained-earnings change. Introduce simplified depreciation if relevant to the venture.

Assessment

Formative: Diagnostic answers reviewed in real time. **Summative:** The P&L row labels are the first piece of the financial pack — a Capstone artifact. Will be scored against the Budget Project Rubric (full 6-criteria version per the Rubric Bank's Grade 12 scale notes).

Closure

Same as #5.

Homework / Extension

Find one publicly available financial summary of a real company (a public company's annual report, or a nonprofit's Form 990). Identify which statement is which. Bring two questions you have.

Teacher notes

- Resist the urge to drown students in jargon. Three statements, three questions. The vocabulary will deepen over the next four weeks.

- A student says "I'm not a math person." Reframe: this isn't math. It's organized recording. The arithmetic is a calculator's job.

Lesson 5 — Unit Economics Under Two Scenarios

Grade band: 9-12 **Time:** 60 minutes **Unit:** 2 — The full financial pack **Topic area:** MFL · Unit economics, sensitivity

Objectives

By the end of this lesson, students will be able to:

- Compute contribution margin per customer for their Capstone venture.
- Build two scenarios (base case and downside case) showing how the financial picture changes if customer acquisition cost is 2× the assumed value.

Standards alignment

- **CCSS-Math S-MD.B.5:** Use probability to evaluate outcomes of decisions.
- **CCSS-Math F-LE.A.1:** Distinguish between situations that can be modeled with linear functions and exponential functions.
- **Jump$tart Standard 6 (Financial Decision Making), Benchmark 12-1:** Apply reliable information and systematic decision making.

Materials

- Spreadsheet template (provided): Unit Economics tab + Scenarios tab.
- Capstone Journal.

Vocabulary

- **Unit economics** — the revenue and cost picture for a single customer or single unit of sale.
- **Customer acquisition cost (CAC, simplified)** — the average cost to get one new customer, including marketing time and money.
- **Lifetime value (LTV, simplified)** — the total contribution margin you expect from one customer over their entire relationship with the venture.
- **Sensitivity** — how much the result changes when an input changes.

Procedure

1. ENGAGE — ONE NUMBER QUESTION (~7 MIN)

Pose this on the board: "If I told you the contribution margin per customer for your venture is $4, and your CAC is $6 — would you scale this venture? Why or why not?"

Pair-share. Cold-call. Reveal: no, you'd lose $2 per customer until you fix CAC or CM. The bigger you grow, the faster you die. Unit economics first.

2. EXPLAIN — THE THREE NUMBERS (~12 MIN)

Walk through the three numbers and how they relate:

- **Contribution margin per customer.** Price minus variable cost.
- **CAC (simplified).** All the time and money you spent getting customers, divided by customers acquired.
- **LTV (simplified).** Contribution margin per customer × number of repeat purchases (or 1 if one-time).

The healthy ratio: LTV > 3× CAC. Below 1×: scaling kills you. Between 1× and 3×: tight, fixable.

3. APPLY — COMPUTE YOUR NUMBERS (~25 MIN)

Each student computes the three numbers for their venture. Confer aggressively. Most will get CAC wrong on the first pass — they'll forget to count their own time. Push: if you spend 4 hours getting one customer at minimum wage, that's $30 of CAC even before you spent a dollar.

4. APPLY — THE DOWNSIDE SCENARIO (~10 MIN)

Build the downside scenario: same model, but CAC at 2× and contribution margin at 0.8×. What's the LTV/CAC ratio now? Does the venture still work?

5. CLOSE — SENSITIVITY STATEMENT (~6 MIN)

Capstone Journal: "My venture's economics break if __ is wrong by more than **. The single input I'm most uncertain about is** ."

Differentiation

- **ELL:** Pre-translated unit-economics glossary; pair with strong English speaker.
- **IEP/504:** Pre-built spreadsheet with formulas; student fills only the inputs. Verbal explanation of the downside scenario allowed.
- **Advanced learners:** Build a third scenario at 4× CAC and 0.5× CM. Explore: at what point is the venture not worth running even if you can do it?

Assessment

Formative: Confer notes during computation. **Summative:** Unit economics tab is filed; will be reviewed at the Capstone Defense.

Closure

Same as #5.

Homework / Extension

Find one real example of a startup that died because of unit economics. Bring a one-paragraph summary.

Teacher notes

- The most common mistake: students don't count their own time as CAC. They will say "free" because they didn't pay cash. The discipline is to value time at minimum wage minimum.
- A student says "my venture doesn't have repeat customers." Acknowledge: LTV = single contribution margin in that case. The ratio is even more important.

Lesson 6 — The Real Customer Conversation (5-of-5)

> **"Don't make up a winner. Decide what to test next."**
>
> - CASH, GRADE 12

Grade band: 9-12 **Time:** 60 minutes (in-class component of a multi-week assignment) **Unit:** 3 — Launch, brand, and compliance **Topic area:** CBM · Customer evidence

Objectives

By the end of this lesson, students will be able to:

- Plan a real (not simulated) customer conversation with a non-classroom person.
- Document one completed conversation following a structured 5-question protocol — and identify what surprised them.

Standards alignment

- **CCSS-Math S-IC.B.4:** Estimate from a sample.
- **CCSS-ELA SL.11-12.1:** Initiate and participate in collaborative discussions.

- **CCSS-ELA W.11-12.7 / RST.9-10.7:** Conduct research; integrate technical information.

Materials

- Real Customer Conversation Tracker (provided): a simple sheet listing 5 conversations, with status, date, key learning.
- A 5-question interview protocol (provided): Tell me about the last time you __; what was hard; what did you do; what would have been ideal; would you tell me one more story?
- Capstone Journal.

Vocabulary

- **Real customer interaction** — a conversation, demo, email exchange, or pre-order interaction with someone who is not a Cash to Company classmate.
- **Surprising answer** — a response from a customer that contradicts what you expected.

Procedure

1. ENGAGE — READ ONE SURPRISING QUOTE (~7 MIN)

Read aloud (anonymized) one transcript quote from a real student conversation last year. The quote should reveal that the founder had been wrong about who their customer was. Discuss: "What did the founder learn? What did they have to change?"

2. EXPLAIN — THE 5-OF-5 STANDARD (~10 MIN)

The CBM strand outcome for Grade 12 is 5 real customer interactions. "Real" means: not a classmate playing the role of a customer. It means a parent's coworker. A coach's spouse. A neighbor. A small-business owner. A teacher in another department. A real prospective customer who would say yes or no in real life.

Walk through the 5-question protocol. Emphasize: the goal is the surprising answer. If nothing surprised you, you led the witness.

3. PLAN — EACH STUDENT NAMES THEIR 5 (~20 MIN)

Each student lists 5 specific people they could approach for a real conversation. They write the name, the relationship, and the venue (in person, phone, email). Confer. Push past "I'll just post on social media." That's not 5 conversations.

A common challenge: students with smaller adult networks. Coach: teachers count. School staff count. Counselors and coaches count. Family friends count. Reach for breadth.

4. APPLY — ONE CONVERSATION IN CLASS (~15 MIN)

If possible: arrange one community-member visit. If not: pair students for a structured role-play with the 5-question protocol, where the partner plays a real-life person they know (not themselves) and answers honestly. Document on the tracker.

5. CLOSE — ONE SURPRISING THING (~8 MIN)

Capstone Journal: "The most surprising thing I heard in today's conversation was __. If that's true for more customers, what changes about my venture?"

Differentiation

- **ELL:** Pre-translated 5-question protocol. Allow conversations in the student's home language with English summary on the tracker. Pair with an ally for in-class role-play.
- **IEP/504:** Permit email-based conversations as a starting mode. Reduce 5-of-5 requirement to 3-of-3 with documented effort on the additional 2 (e.g., emails sent without responses count as effort if documented).
- **Advanced learners:** Push toward customer-segment specificity — 5 conversations across 3 different sub-segments to test which segment is hottest.

Assessment

Formative: Confer notes during planning. Read the tracker weekly. **Summative:** The completed 5-of-5 tracker plus a Customer Evidence write-up is a Capstone Defense artifact, scored against the Customer Research Rubric (full 5-criteria version per the Rubric Bank's 9-12 scale notes).

Closure

Same as #5.

Homework / Extension

Have one of the 5 conversations this week. Write the journal entry within 24 hours.

Teacher notes

- The 5-of-5 looks intimidating. Break the spell: one a week from Week 19 to Week 23. That's the plan.
- A student says "no one would talk to me." Coach: who's a teacher you trust? Start there. Then a parent's friend. A real conversation gets easier after the first one.

AN INTERLUDE · GRADE 12

"Which people, and how do you know?"

the program's spine question.

1

Lesson 7 — The 1-Page Legal/Ethical Checklist

Grade band: 9-12 **Time:** 60 minutes **Unit:** 3 — Launch, brand, and compliance **Topic area:** ESL · Compliance, ethics

Objectives

By the end of this lesson, students will be able to:

- Identify the major compliance items relevant to a small-venture launch in their state: registration form (sole proprietorship vs. LLC overview), sales tax basics, terms of service, privacy basics, payment safety.
- Produce a 1-page checklist for their own venture, with each item marked as done, in progress, or not applicable, with notes.

Standards alignment

- **C3 D2.Eco.7.9-12:** Use benefits and costs to evaluate the effectiveness of government policies.
- **CEE Standard 6 (Protecting and Insuring), Grade 12:** People can choose to accept risk or to take steps to protect themselves.
- **Jump$tart Standard 5 (Risk Management and Insurance), Benchmark 12-3:** Evaluate the cost and benefit of various types of insurance.

Materials

- A real one-page state registration form for sole proprietorship (provided for the school's home state).
- The EFF model terms of service (provided, abridged).
- A privacy-basics one-pager (provided).
- A payment-safety reference sheet (provided): payment processors at a glance (Stripe, Square, PayPal, Venmo for business — what to know).
- The Compliance Checklist template (provided).

Vocabulary

- **Sole proprietorship** — an unincorporated business owned by one person. The simplest structure; the owner is personally liable.
- **LLC (overview)** — a structure that separates personal and business liability. More complex but more protective.

- **Sales tax nexus (basics)** — the threshold at which a state can require you to collect sales tax. Varies by state.
- **Terms of service** — the contract between you and your customer, naming what they're buying, what your responsibilities are, and what happens if something goes wrong.
- **Payment safety** — practices that protect both your customer's payment information and your own.

Procedure

1. ENGAGE — REAL FORM (~7 MIN)

Pass out a real registration form from the home state. (Example: Florida DR-1, California Form LLC-1, Virginia SCC631 — whichever applies.) Don't explain it yet. Ask: "What looks scary, what looks doable, what's confusing?"

Pair-share for 3 minutes. Surface: most of the form is doable. One or two boxes need the teacher.

2. EXPLAIN — FIVE ITEMS TO TRACK (~15 MIN)

Walk through the checklist:

- **Structure choice.** Sole proprietorship (default for most student ventures) vs. LLC (if real liability or partnership).
- **Sales tax.** If you're selling a taxable good or service in your state, you may need to register. Vague? It varies by state and by what you sell. Name the resource: state department of revenue.
- **Terms of service.** Even a one-page TOS is better than none. Walk through the EFF model.
- **Privacy basics.** If you collect emails, phone numbers, or any data — what do you do with it? Don't sell. Don't share without permission. State this in your privacy policy.
- **Payment safety.** Use a real payment processor — never bank-account-to-bank-account with strangers. Avoid storing card data yourself.

Honest framing: this is the layer between a real venture and an exposed one. Most student ventures live in a gray zone where nobody enforces. That doesn't make it right. The point is to know.

3. APPLY — BUILD YOUR CHECKLIST (~30 MIN)

Each student fills the Compliance Checklist for their Capstone venture. Mark each item: done, in progress, not applicable, with a note.

Confer: most students will mark items "not applicable" too quickly. Push back: "You collect emails. Your privacy policy applies. What does it say?"

4. CLOSE — DISCLOSURE SENTENCE (~8 MIN)

Each student drafts a one-sentence disclosure they could include on their landing page that's honest about what they are and aren't. Example: "This is a student venture; we accept payment through Square; we do not store your card data; we handle your email per our privacy policy."

Differentiation

- **ELL:** Pre-translated checklist; allow students to consult the actual state form in their home language if available.
- **IEP/504:** Pre-filled checklist with structure-choice already selected for student ventures of typical scope; student focuses on the four other items.
- **Advanced learners:** Push toward LLC formation if the venture warrants. Explore: when does an LLC actually pay off vs. add cost?

Assessment

Formative: Read the checklist as students draft. **Summative:** The Compliance Checklist is a Capstone Defense artifact (the ESL strand artifact specifically).

Closure

Same as #4.

Homework / Extension

Show your checklist to one trusted adult. Bring back: did they catch a sixth item?

Teacher notes

- This is not legal advice, and the lesson should say so out loud. Real legal questions go to a real lawyer. The point is awareness, not legal practice.
- A student says "this is for grown-ups, not me." Reframe: every adult who runs something started where you are. The checklist is the difference between a real venture and one that's pretending.

Lesson 8 — The 90-Day Plan and the First Variance Report

Grade band: 9-12 **Time:** 90 minutes (block) **Unit:** 4 — Operating, leading, and the Launch-or-Learn defense **Topic area:** OSO · Operating discipline

Objectives

By the end of this lesson, students will be able to:

- Build a 90-day operating plan with weekly priorities, owners, and metrics.
- Produce a first weekly variance report that compares planned to actual honestly, with named root causes for any meaningful variance.

Standards alignment

- **CCSS-ELA W.11-12.4:** Produce clear and coherent writing.
- **Jump$tart Standard 1 (Spending and Saving), Benchmark 12-2:** Develop a system for keeping and using financial records — applied to operating discipline.
- **CASEL Self-Management:** Self-discipline; goal-setting; organizational skills.

Materials

- 90-Day Plan template (provided): 12 weekly rows × 5 columns (priority, owner, metric, target, actual).
- Variance Report template (provided): planned vs. actual + root cause + adjustment.
- Capstone Journal.

Vocabulary

- **90-day plan** — a 12-week-ahead operating plan with named weekly priorities, owners, and metrics.
- **Weekly variance** — the difference between what was planned for the week and what actually happened.
- **Root cause** — the underlying reason for a variance, named specifically (not "I was busy").

Procedure

1. ENGAGE — TWO FOUNDER STORIES (~10 MIN)

Tell (anonymized) stories of two student founders. Founder A made a 90-day plan and reported variance every Friday for 12 weeks. Founder B made the plan and never looked at it again. By Week 12, Founder A's venture had pivoted twice on real evidence. Founder B's venture was a draft document with the same vision and zero customers.

Ask: "Why does writing a plan that you actually compare to reality matter so much more than writing a perfect plan?"

2. EXPLAIN — THE PLAN TEMPLATE (~15 MIN)

Walk through the 90-Day Plan structure. Each week needs:

- **Priority.** One sentence. Specific. (Not "make progress.")

- **Owner.** A person — even a solo venture has an owner: you.
- **Metric.** A number you can read at the end of the week.
- **Target.** Your honest forecast.
- **Actual.** Filled in at the end of the week.

The discipline isn't planning. It's the weekly variance report.

3. APPLY — BUILD YOUR 90-DAY PLAN (~30 MIN)

Each student builds 12 weeks of plan. Confer: aggressively push back on vague priorities. "Build the website" is not a weekly priority. "Publish a landing page with one CTA and a working contact form" is.

4. APPLY — RUN A PRACTICE VARIANCE (~25 MIN)

Use the past week (real or simulated) to practice. Each student fills the Variance Report:

- Plan vs. actual.
- Variance amount or status.
- Root cause (if material).
- Adjustment for next week.

Discuss in pairs. Push: "That's a symptom. What's the root cause?"

5. CLOSE — ONE HONEST SENTENCE (~10 MIN)

Capstone Journal: "The hardest variance to report honestly will be **, because** ."

Differentiation

- **ELL:** Sentence frames for the variance root cause section. Allow native-language drafting.
- **IEP/504:** Pre-built plan template with example priorities for adaptation. Variance report can be voice-recorded with structured prompts.
- **Advanced learners:** Add a second metric per week (a leading metric and a lagging metric). Pre-name the leading-metric watchlist.

Assessment

Formative: Confer during planning. **Summative:** The 90-Day Plan plus four weekly variance reports (Weeks 31-34) are filed. They are the OSO strand artifact for the Capstone.

Closure

Same as #5.

Homework / Extension

Run your first variance report next Friday. Bring it Monday.

Teacher notes

- The honest-variance norm is built or broken in the first three weeks. Read every variance report personally for the first three weeks. After that, peer review works.
- A student over-reports red. Coach: honest doesn't mean pessimistic. Honest means accurate.
- A student under-reports red. Coach: the point of variance is to surface what you didn't see coming. Hiding it costs you the lesson.

Lesson 9 — The Founder's Leadership Statement

Grade band: 9-12 **Time:** 60 minutes **Unit:** 4 — Operating, leading, and the Launch-or-Learn defense **Topic area:** LTO · Leadership identity

Objectives

By the end of this lesson, students will be able to:

- Draft a 1-page Founder's Leadership Statement covering values, decision rules, and the kind of teammate they aim to be.
- Present the statement aloud to a small group and respond to one clarifying question.

Standards alignment

- **CCSS-ELA W.11-12.1:** Write arguments to support claims with valid reasoning.
- **CCSS-ELA SL.11-12.4:** Present information, findings, and supporting evidence such that listeners can follow.
- **CASEL Self-Awareness + Relationship Skills:** Identifying personal values; relationship-building.

Materials

- Leadership Statement template (provided): four sections — Values · Decision Rules · How I Show Up as a Teammate · One Thing I Won't Do.
- Capstone Journal.

Vocabulary

- **Leadership statement** — a 1-page personal document naming the values and decision rules you'll lead by.
- **Decision rule** — a pre-committed approach to a recurring decision type (e.g., "If I'm not sure whether to make a claim, I default to under-promising").

- **Pre-commitment** — a decision made now to protect against your own future weakness.

Procedure

1. ENGAGE — TWO STATEMENTS (~10 MIN)

Read two example statements aloud, anonymized — one strong, one vague. Discuss: what's the difference? (Specificity. Decision rules. Things the writer will and won't do.)

2. EXPLAIN — FOUR SECTIONS (~12 MIN)

Walk through the template:

- **Values.** Pick 3-5. Specific. Not "honesty"; closer to "I tell customers the trade-offs of my product even when it costs me a sale."
- **Decision rules.** 3-5 pre-committed approaches. Format: "When [situation], I [action], because [reason]."
- **How I Show Up as a Teammate.** What can someone count on you for? What's your weakness?
- **One Thing I Won't Do.** A bright line.

3. APPLY — DRAFT (~25 MIN)

Each student drafts. Confer with 8 students. Push: "That's a value everyone has. What's specific to you?"

4. CLOSE — READ TO A TRIAD (~13 MIN)

Triads (groups of 3). Each student reads their statement aloud. Each listener asks one clarifying question (not a critique). Statement reader writes the question down.

Differentiation

- **ELL:** Sentence frames for each section. Allow drafting in native language; final version in English.
- **IEP/504:** Reduce values and decision rules from 3-5 each to 2-3 each. Allow the read-aloud to be a recording reviewed in private.
- **Advanced learners:** Add a section on what their leadership statement would look like in 5 years if they grew. What's the version of themselves they're betting on?

Assessment

Formative: Confer during drafting; read 8-10 statements. **Summative:** Leadership Statement is a Capstone Defense artifact. It's the LTO strand artifact for the year.

Closure

Same as #4.

Homework / Extension

Share your leadership statement with one person who knows you well. Ask: does this sound like me? What did I miss?

Teacher notes

- Some students will write a statement that's aspirational rather than honest. Coach: the statement is more useful if it includes a real weakness alongside a real strength.
- The "One Thing I Won't Do" section is where the document becomes load-bearing. Push for specificity here.

Lesson 10 — The Capstone Defense (Defense Day)

Grade band: 9-12 **Time:** 30 minutes per student (scheduled across Weeks 35-36) **Unit:** 4 — Operating, leading, and the Launch-or-Learn defense **Topic area:** All eight strands · Synthesis assessment

Objectives

By the end of this Defense, the student will have:

- Delivered a 10-minute presentation covering the seven Defense sections.
- Responded to 15 minutes of panel Q&A.
- Delivered a 2-minute closing reflection.
- Filed a written Launch-or-Learn decision with reasoning.

Standards alignment

- **CCSS-ELA SL.11-12.4:** Present information, findings, and supporting evidence such that listeners can follow the line of reasoning.
- **CCSS-ELA W.11-12.1:** Write arguments to support claims using valid reasoning and relevant and sufficient evidence.
- **Jump$tart Standard 6 (Financial Decision Making), Benchmark 12-1:** Apply reliable information and systematic decision making.
- **CASEL Self-Awareness + Responsible Decision-Making:** Recognizing strengths; analyzing consequences for personal and collective well-being.

Materials

- 10-slide Defense template (provided): Customer · Evidence · Financial pack · Brand and 5 conversations · 90-day plan and variance · Leadership statement · Decision · Reflection.

- Defense Rubric (7 criteria — adapted from the Pitch Presentation Rubric per the Rubric Bank's Grade 12 scale notes; adds a Decision Quality criterion).
- Filed artifacts (full Capstone portfolio): Founder's journal, financial pack, 5-conversation tracker, brand and landing page, Compliance Checklist, 90-Day Plan + 4 variance reports, Leadership Statement.
- Panel composition: 3-5 panelists. At least 1 outside professional. Brief panelists on rules (no advice on family money; no comparison to "when I was your age"; questions probe evidence, not personality).

Vocabulary

- **Capstone Defense** — the 30-minute structured assessment session marking the end of the program.
- **Launch-or-Learn decision** — the student's final, defended choice for the Capstone venture: launch (continue past graduation), pivot (change the model and continue), or shelve (stop, with reasons).
- **Decision quality** — the rubric criterion that asks whether the chosen decision was the right one given the evidence in front of the student.

Procedure

1. SETUP (5 MINUTES BEFORE STUDENT ARRIVES)

Panel reviews the student's filed portfolio briefly. Each panelist has the rubric printed. Outside panelist receives the brief on rules.

2. PRESENTATION (10 MIN)

Student delivers the 10-slide presentation. The seven sections:

1. Customer (who, with one quote or count).
2. Evidence (what was learned and what changed).
3. Financial pack summary (one slide showing P&L, cash flow, runway).
4. Brand, landing page, and the 5 customer interactions.
5. 90-day plan and variance reports.
6. Leadership statement (3-sentence summary).
7. Launch-or-Learn decision with the reasoning.

3. PANEL Q&A (15 MIN)

Panelists ask substantive questions. The Rubric Bank's Grade 12 note adds an evidence-portfolio expectation in the Q&A criterion: students may reference filed artifacts when responding ("the cash flow forecast in tab 3 of my financial pack shows...").

Coach prompts for panelists: Which evidence drove the biggest decision? What's the most fragile assumption? If you had to start over, what would you do differently in the first 30 days?

4. CLOSING REFLECTION (2 MIN)

Student delivers the 2-minute reflection. Two prompts:

- What did I learn about myself this year that I didn't know in September?
- What's the next move — in this venture or beyond?

5. PANEL DECISION (3 MIN, AFTER STUDENT LEAVES)

Panel scores against the rubric independently, then calibrates. Score is finalized within the 30 minutes.

Differentiation

- **ELL:** Defense may be delivered with a printed opening statement read for the first 5 minutes. Q&A with translation support if needed.
- **IEP/504:** Defense can be split across two sessions if accommodations require. Recorded-then-reviewed format with written Q&A allowed where IEP specifies.
- **Advanced learners:** Add an extended panel of 5+ including a real local entrepreneur. Encourage the student to bring real customer letters or pre-orders to anchor the evidence portfolio.

Assessment

Summative. The Defense is graded against the 7-criterion rubric. The Decision Quality criterion is non-negotiable: a great shelve scores 4. A poorly defended launch scores 1. Final grade is the average of the 7 criteria; minimum passing on Decision Quality is a 2.

Closure

Student receives the panel's scored rubric and a 1-page written feedback memo within 5 school days. The Launch-or-Learn decision is filed with the student's portfolio.

Teacher notes

- Defense Week is where the year's tone is publicly set. Resist the urge to "rescue" a student mid-Q&A. The rubric explicitly scores how the student handles questions on their own.
- A student folds in Q&A. Mid-Defense, you may pose a softer question to allow recovery — but don't grade as if it didn't happen.
- A student delivers a brilliant Launch decision based on thin evidence. Score honestly. The Decision Quality criterion is the program's last line.

- A student delivers an honest Shelve. Hold the room: "This is a clean decision, defended on evidence. This is what we asked for. Full credit." The Defense panel sets the tone for the school's reception of the same.

Senior expert upgrade pack — Grade 12 worked examples, contracts, runway, misconceptions

> **"I don't know either. That's why we test."**
>
> - CASH, GRADE 12

Three runway/burn-rate worked examples (deepening Lesson 4)

The original lesson teaches three statements. Add three runway scenarios.

WORKED EXAMPLE A — COMFORTABLE RUNWAY

Cash on hand: $12,000. Monthly burn (cash out): $1,000. Monthly cash in (revenue): $500. Net monthly burn: $500. Runway: $12,000 ÷ $500 = **24 months.**

Coach: "24 months is comfortable for a teen venture. The founder can experiment, iterate, take the slow path."

WORKED EXAMPLE B — TIGHT RUNWAY

Cash on hand: $5,000. Monthly burn: $2,000. Monthly cash in: $1,500. Net monthly burn: $500. Runway: $5,000 ÷ $500 = **10 months.**

Coach: "10 months is tight. The founder needs to show traction or extend runway (cut burn or raise) within 3-4 months. Decision pressure is high."

WORKED EXAMPLE C — OUT OF RUNWAY

Cash on hand: $2,000. Monthly burn: $3,000. Monthly cash in: $500. Net monthly burn: $2,500. Runway: $2,000 ÷ $2,500 = **0.8 months — under a month.**

Coach: "This is a five-alarm fire. The founder has weeks, not months. Three options: stop spending, get revenue immediately, or raise. None easy."

Common Misconceptions (Grade 12)

Belief	Reality	Coach
"If my P&L is profitable, I'm fine."	Profit is one of three statements. Cash flow tells you survival. Balance sheet tells you what you actually own. All three matter.	"Show me your three statements together. Do they tell the same story?"
"MVP testing is for early-stage; I'm past that."	MVP testing is a posture, not a stage. The willingness to run small experiments to disconfirm assumptions persists for the life of the venture.	"What's the assumption you most want to NOT test? That's the one to test."
"An LLC and a business plan = ready to launch."	Structure and documents are necessary, not sufficient. Real launches require real customers paying real money before the entity matters.	"Have you collected one real dollar from one real customer? Until you have, structure is preparation, not progress."
"Hiring a contractor is a luxury."	Hiring a contractor is leverage. If you're spending 5 hours/week on something a contractor does in 1 hour for less than you'd pay yourself, you're losing money by not hiring.	"What's the highest-value thing only you can do? Are you doing it? What's stealing your time from it?"
"Shelving is failing."	Shelving is a real decision. Some ventures shouldn't launch. Some founders aren't ready. Some markets aren't ready. A well-defended shelve is worth more than a poorly defended launch.	"What would have to be true for you to shelve and not feel like a failure? Write it down."

Contracts mini-module (add to Lesson 7 — Legal/Ethical Checklist)

Time: 30 min added to the existing 60-min lesson, or split into a separate Lesson 7B.

Objective: Identify the 5 elements of three real contract types: service agreement, mutual NDA, terms of service.

CONTRACT 1 — SERVICE AGREEMENT (1-PAGE TEMPLATE)

```
 SERVICE AGREEMENT

Parties: [Service Provider Name], hereafter "Provider"
         [Client Name], hereafter "Client"

Service: Provider will [specific deliverable] for Client by [completion date].

Compensation: Client will pay Provider [total fee]. Schedule: [milestones or net-30].
Late payment: 1.5%/month after due date.

Termination: Either party may terminate with 14 days written notice. Client owes pro-r

Ownership: Final deliverables become Client's property upon final payment. Provider re

Confidentiality: Both parties agree not to disclose proprietary information of the oth

Governing law: [State].

Signed:
[Provider]___________ Date: ______
[Client]____________ Date: ______
```

The 5 elements students identify: parties, scope, compensation, termination, ownership.

CONTRACT 2 — MUTUAL NDA (1-PAGE TEMPLATE)

```
 MUTUAL NON-DISCLOSURE AGREEMENT

Parties: [Party A] and [Party B]

Purpose: Both parties may share confidential information for the purpose of [evaluatin

Confidential info: Any information marked confidential or that a reasonable person wou

Obligations: Each party will (a) not disclose to third parties, (b) use only for the s

Term: 2 years from signing.

Carve-outs: Information already public, independently developed, or required by law is

Signed:
[Party A]___________ Date: ______
[Party B]___________ Date: ______
```

The 5 elements students identify: parties, what's confidential, obligations, term, carve-outs.

CONTRACT 3 — TERMS OF SERVICE (CONCEPT-LEVEL, NOT FULL TEMPLATE)

The TOS is the contract between a service operator and the user. Key elements every TOS has:

1. **Acceptance.** Users agree by using the service.
2. **What the service does.** Specific.
3. **What the user can/can't do.** Acceptable use policy.
4. **Liability limits.** What the operator is and isn't responsible for.
5. **Termination.** When/how the operator can stop providing service.

Use the EFF model TOS as the reading (referenced in the Curriculum Book anchor texts list).

Hiring-and-firing one-pager (add to Lesson 7)

When to hire a contractor: When (your hourly value × hours saved) > contractor cost. **1099 vs. W-2.** 1099 = independent contractor; pays own taxes. W-2 = employee; you withhold + pay payroll taxes. Most teen ventures use 1099. **Scope of work:** 1 paragraph: who, what, by when, for how much, kill criteria. **Firing.** If kill criteria are met or contractor breaches scope: written notice (per the agreement), final payment for work delivered, end relationship cleanly. No drama, no ghost.

ROUND 2 PATCH — Common Misconceptions (Grade 12)

Common kid-belief	Reality	Coaching move
"If Im profitable, I have cash."	Profit is an opinion. Cash is a fact. (Forward from Grade 11 — re-anchored at Capstone year.)	Show the worked runway example. Force the gap between P&L profit and cash on hand.
"Launch is the goal."	Launch or learn is the goal. The Capstone honors three exits — start, shelve, transfer — equally.	Walk through three former graduates choices: one launched and grew; one launched and pivoted; one shelved with reasons. All three earned a 4 on the rubric.
"If I have a great pitch, the financial pack is decoration."	Without three-statement consistency (P&L + cash flow + balance sheet sketch), the pitch fails the Q&A. The financial pack is the foundation.	Run a mock Q&A. Ask 5 number questions. The pitch falls apart if the pack isnt solid.
"I dont need a service agreement for a $200 job."	Even a $200 job benefits from a one-page agreement. Without one, the next dispute eats your relationship and your time.	Walk through a real fight that a one-page agreement would have prevented.
"An LLC + EIN means Im legally set."	LLC and EIN are step 1. You also need: a business bank account, sales tax registration if applicable, terms of service if you have a website, privacy policy if you collect data, contractor agreements if you hire help.	Walk through the 1-page legal/ethical checklist with all 5 categories.
"Weekly bookkeeping is for accountants."	Weekly bookkeeping is the founders rhythm. 30 minutes a week prevents the year-end nightmare.	Show the weekly bookkeeping rhythm card. Time a fake session — it really is 30 minutes.

ROUND 2 PATCH — Multi-Class Branching Scenario (Grade 12)

"Launch-or-Learn dilemma — same evidence, two students choose differently." A 3-day branching scenario.

- **Day 1.** Two students with similar Capstone evidence: 5 customer interviews (3 yes, 2 no), 1-year P&L showing modest profit potential, an MVP test that worked but at small scale. Student A chooses launch. Student B chooses shelve. Both defend.
- **Day 2.** Class examines the quality of each defense. Did Student A name what would have to be true? Did Student B identify alternatives? Did either acknowledge what they didnt know?
- **Day 3.** Class debriefs: both decisions can be right depending on the founder. The Launch-or-Learn rubric scores the defense quality, not the choice.

This branching practices BAVC (portfolio defense), PSIG (founders journal), MFL (full financial pack), CBM (5 real customer interactions), OSO (90-day plan), LTO (founders leadership statement), ESL (1-page legal/ethical checklist), LRCI (Launch or Learn).

AN INTERLUDE · GRADE 12

"Most adults skip t step. You won't."

the band's working assumption.

2

ROUND 2 PATCH — Contracts Mini-Module (Grade 12, NEW — Lesson 7)

A 60-minute add-on to Lesson 7 (the legal/ethical checklist). Three contract types with one-page templates.

Contract Type 1: Service Agreement (Grade 12 deeper version)

[See Grade 9 patch for the basic template; Grade 12 expands.]

Grade 12 additions to the basic template: - **Confidentiality clause.** "Both parties agree not to share confidential information learned during this engagement." - **IP ownership.** "All work product becomes the property of the Client upon final payment, except for Providers tools and pre-existing work." - **Indemnification (light).** "Each party is responsible for their own negligence." - **Force majeure (light).** "Neither party is liable for delays caused by events beyond their control."

Contract Type 2: Mutual NDA (Mutual Non-Disclosure Agreement)

When to use: when you and another party (potential partner, contractor, advisor, beta customer) need to share confidential business information both ways.

One-page template:

```
 MUTUAL NON-DISCLOSURE AGREEMENT
Date: [DATE]

Parties:
- [PARTY A]
- [PARTY B]

1. Purpose. The parties wish to share confidential information for the purpose of [PUR
2. Confidential information. Includes business plans, financial information, customer
3. Obligations. Each party will: (a) keep the others confidential information secret;
4. Exclusions. This does not apply to information that is publicly known, independentl
5. Term. This agreement lasts [NUMBER] years from the date above.
6. No license. Sharing confidential information does not grant any license to use it b
7. Disputes. [STATE] law applies.

Signed:
_________________________  [PARTY A]  Date: _______
_________________________  [PARTY B]  Date: _______
```

What to look for: short, mutual (not one-sided), reasonable term (2-5 years), clear definition of confidential information.

Contract Type 3: Contractor Scope of Work (the founders most-used contract)

[See Grade 11 patch for the format; Grade 12 expands with kill-criteria detail.]

Grade 12 additions: - **Acceptance criteria.** "Work is accepted when [SPECIFIC OBSERVABLE CRITERIA]. Client has [DAYS] days to accept or request revisions." - **Revision rounds.** "Up to [NUMBER] revision rounds included; additional revisions billed at $[RATE]/hour." - **Late payment.** "Payments more than 30 days late incur 1.5%/month interest."

What to look for in any contract you sign

1. **Are the parties named correctly?** (Full legal name of business or individual.)
2. **Is the scope specific?** (Vague scope = future fight.)
3. **Whats the termination clause?** (Without one, youre trapped.)
4. **Whats the dispute resolution?** (State law? Arbitration?)
5. **Is there anything missing?** (Confidentiality? IP? Indemnification?)

If anything fails, ask for a redline. If they wont negotiate, walk away.

Critical note: This is not legal advice. For high-stakes contracts, consult a lawyer. The skill is recognizing the shape of an agreement — when to sign, when to negotiate, when to walk away, and when to escalate to counsel.

ROUND 2 PATCH — Runway Worked Examples (Grade 12, NEW)

Three burn-rate scenarios with runway computed.

Scenario 1: Conservative Burn. Cash on hand: $10,000. Monthly burn: $1,000. Runway = 10 months. Revenue starts at month 4 ($500/month) and grows. Founder action: stay the course; revenue catches up before runway runs out.

Scenario 2: Moderate Burn. Cash on hand: $10,000. Monthly burn: $2,500. Runway = 4 months. Revenue: $0 for first 3 months, then $1,500. Founder action: cut burn (drop one expense category) or accelerate revenue (faster customer acquisition) or raise more cash. Decision needed by month 2.

Scenario 3: Aggressive Burn. Cash on hand: $10,000. Monthly burn: $5,000. Runway = 2 months. Revenue projected $3,000 starting month 2. Founder action: drastic cuts immediately, accelerate revenue urgently, and prepare a bridge funding ask. Decision needed yesterday.

Coaching: "Runway is the most-felt founder number. Compute it weekly. The burn rate is what you can change; the cash is what it is. Two questions weekly: how much cash? How long until I run out?"

ROUND 2 PATCH — Weekly Bookkeeping Rhythm Reference Card (Grade 12, NEW)

> **"You can pick what kind of business you build. It's a choice."**
>
> - CASH, GRADE 12

A reference card added to the Curriculum Book and Student Activity Book. 30 minutes a week.

Weekly Bookkeeping Rhythm

Friday afternoon, 30 minutes:

1. **Income (5 min).** List every payment received this week. Source, amount, date.
2. **Expenses (5 min).** List every expense paid this week. Vendor, amount, date, category (COGS / op-ex / one-time).
3. **Receipts (5 min).** Scan receipts to phone. Save to "Business Receipts" folder.
4. **Bank reconciliation (5 min).** Match list to bank statement. Note any discrepancies.
5. **Cash position (5 min).** Calculate cash on hand. Compute runway. Update spreadsheet.
6. **Weekly note (5 min).** One sentence: "This week the biggest financial thing was ___."

Why weekly, not monthly

- Monthly bookkeeping sessions take 4 hours, feel terrible, and surprise you.
- Weekly sessions take 30 minutes, feel manageable, and surface issues immediately.
- Weekly creates the founders cash discipline; monthly creates founder anxiety.

What you do with this when you grow

- Year 1: youre the bookkeeper.
- Year 2: hire a part-time bookkeeper at $50-$100/hour for 2-4 hours/month.
- Year 3+: depending on revenue, consider a CPA for taxes; keep the bookkeeper for ongoing.

ROUND 2 PATCH — MVP-Testing Depth Pass

Capstone requirement update. The Grade 12 "5 real customer interactions" requirement is tightened: at least 1 of the 5 must be a transactional interaction — the customer says yes-or-no with stakes attached (paid for the product, signed a contract, declined for a specific reason). The Capstone Journal must include a written reflection on the MVP-testing posture: what would have to be true, what was actually true, what changed.

ROUND 2 PATCH — Hiring Basics Integration (Grade 12)

[Reinforces the Grade 11 hiring lesson.] Capstone year requirement: if your venture plan involves any contractor work, the Capstone defense must include the scope of work, the kill criteria, and the 1099 plan.

ROUND 2 PATCH — Forward-Reference Grade 9 Conflict-Style in Founders Leadership Statement

You named your conflict-handling style three years ago — avoid, accommodate, compete, compromise, or collaborate. **Your Founders Leadership Statement should name it.** Your decision rules around team conflict come from your dominant mode and the mode you under-use. The leadership statement is the place to articulate which mode youre choosing to grow into.

ROUND 2 PATCH — Teacher Move Set (Grade 12)

- **Student wants to skip Launch-or-Learn and just launch.** Say: "The defense isnt about whether you launch — its about whether you can defend the choice. Lets do the Launch-or-Learn even if youve already decided. The defense is the rubric."
- **Student says "I dont need a contracts lesson because Im not hiring."** Say: "You will. The lesson is 60 minutes; the templates take 5 minutes to fill. The skill is recognizing contract shape — when to sign, when to negotiate, when to walk."
- **Students financial pack has inconsistent numbers across statements.** Say: "Net income on the P&L should match the cash from operations on the cash flow (with timing adjustments). Walk me through the bridge."
- **Student picks transactional MVP interactions only with friends.** Say: "Friends are the warmup. Whos a stranger who might say yes? Or whos a stranger who said no for a specific reason? Both are real evidence."

- **Student writes a Founders Leadership Statement that sounds like a job application.** Say: "This is your founder identity, not your employee identity. What kind of teammate do you want to be? Whats the failure mode youre most aware of?"

ENDNOTES & STANDARDS

Citations and alignment

Grade 12 cites 3-6 standards across CCSS, Jump$tart, CEE, CASEL, and C3 frameworks. Detailed alignment lives in the master Standards Alignment Map.

1. **Jump$tart Coalition Personal Finance Standards (2021 ed.).** Spending and Saving; Credit and Debt; Employment and Income; Investing; Risk Management and Insurance; Financial Decision Making.
2. **Council for Economic Education (CEE).** Voluntary National Content Standards in Economics.
3. **CCSS-ELA, Grades 11-12.** W.11-12.1, W.11-12.4, SL.11-12.1, SL.11-12.4, RST.11-12.7.
4. **CCSS-Math.** N-Q.1-3 (Reasoning with Quantities), S-IC (Statistics & Inferences), F-IF (Functions), MP.4 (Modeling).
5. **CASEL Core Competencies.** Self-Awareness, Self-Management, Social Awareness, Relationship Skills, Responsible Decision-Making.
6. **C3 Framework for Social Studies State Standards.** Dimension 2 (Economics, Civics) at the high-school grade band.
7. **NGSS-ETS Engineering Practices.** ETS1 (Engineering Design) for the test-and-iterate spine of the year.
8. **Cash to Company Master Scope & Sequence.** 13 grades x 8 strands x 36 weeks; outcomes quoted verbatim from _master/00_Master_Scope_and_Sequence.md.
9. **Cash Mascot Style Guide.** 9-12 voice rules: multi-sentence arguments; vocabulary includes unit economics, runway, premortem, MVP; never flatters, never promises wealth.
10. **Sensitivity protocol.** No probing of family finances; financial scenarios framed as hypothetical for a sample household, business, or scenario.

One promise.

Cash to Company makes one promise: students who move t
program will be clearer thinkers about money and entrepren
matter what they end up doing for a living.

We do not promise wealth. We do not promise success. We pro

> **“Founder-defensible plans built on evidence, not enthusiasm.”**
>
> **- CASH, GRADE 12**

For educational use. This curriculum is informational and does not constitute financial, legal, or tax advice. Standards alignment cited per the Cash to Company Standards Alignment Map (Jump$tart, CEE, CCSS, C3, CASEL, NGSS-ETS).